



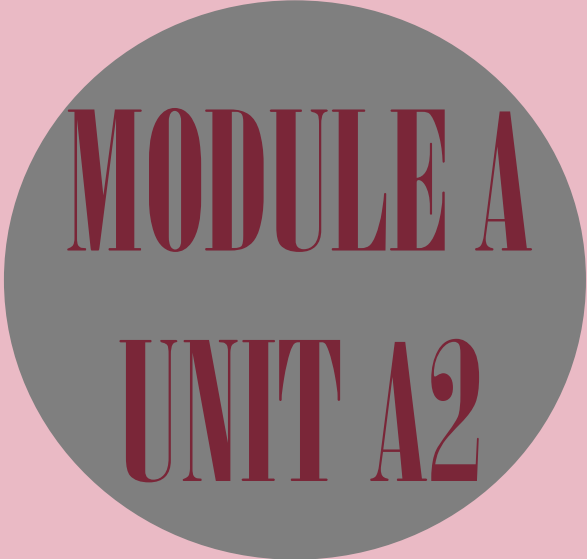
Universidad Tecnológica Nacional
Facultad Regional Villa María

INGLÉS 2

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MODULE A

UNIT A2

Self-study Preview

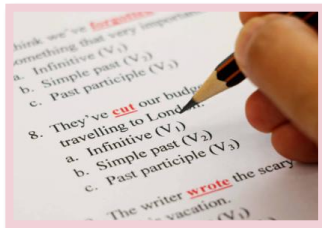
Comparative and Superlative Forms:

- ✓ <https://www.mansioningles.com/Gram13.htm> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <https://www.britishcouncil.org.mx/blog/comparativos-superlativos-en-ingles> (Section: Grammar).
- ✓ <http://original.ompersonal.com.ar/INTERMEDIATE/unit14/page2.htm> (Sections: Grammar x 2, Useful Info).
- ✓ <https://english.lingolia.com/es/gramatica/adjetivos/adjetivos> (Section: Grammar).

The background of the slide is a photograph of a wooden desk. On the desk, there is a silver laptop, a white coffee cup on a saucer, several crumpled pieces of white paper, a pencil, and a small notepad. A semi-transparent white rectangular box with a dark red border is centered over the image, containing the title text.

Comparatives and superlatives

- We use comparatives to show change or make comparisons. Comparative adjectives compare **two** things, people, or places. Frequently, the word **than** accompanies the comparative adjective. You can omit “than” when it is clear from context:



The last English test was **more difficult than** the previous one.

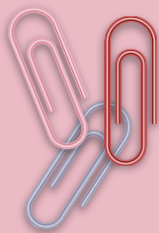
The last English test was **more difficult**.

Paul is **taller than** John.

The **taller** boy is Paul.



more
expensive
important
cheaper
better
interesting
intelligent
big
than



1 SYLLABLE:
+ -ER / -R

OLD

OLDER

CHEAP

CHEAPER

NICE

NICER

1 SYLLABLE:
CONSONANT – VOWEL
– CONSONANT: **DOBLE**
CONSONANT + -ER

HOT

HOTTER

BIG

BIGGER

THIN

THINNER

2 SYLLABLES ENDING
IN -Y: -Y → -IER

HEALTHY

HEALTHIER

HAPPY

HAPPIER

EARLY

EARLIER

2 OR MORE SYLLABLES:
MORE/LESS +
ADJECTIVE

FAMOUS

MORE FAMOUS

DIFFICULT

MORE DIFFICULT

MODERN

MORE MODERN

- Some adjectives do not follow the rules (*-er or more*) when they build their comparative form:



GOOD	BETTER
BAD	WORSE
FAR	FURTHER/FARTHER*
LITTLE	LESS
MUCH / MANY	MORE

* When we talk about distance, both “further/farther” are possible.

However, when we mean extra or additional, we can only use “further”:

Newcastle is further/farther north than York.

but: If you need further information, please get in touch.

- Comparatives can also be used to show how one thing depends on another:



The healthier you eat, **the better** you feel.

A: 'Do you like strong coffee?' B: 'Yes, I do. **The** stronger, **the better**.

The harder he works, **the more stressed** he is.

The faster you drive, **the more dangerous** it is.

These statements show universal truths and demonstrate that as one thing happens, another follows. “The”, in these cases, is used before the comparative to show a relationship of dependency.

MORE & MORE

- Comparatives can also demonstrate change over time:

Exams keep getting **tougher and tougher**.

Houses are getting **more and more** expensive.

This book gets **more and more interesting** with every chapter.

The first example shows how exams continue to increase in difficulty, the second how house prices continue to go up, and the last example how the book gets better chapter after chapter. The same comparative adjective repeated using “and” expresses an ongoing trend.



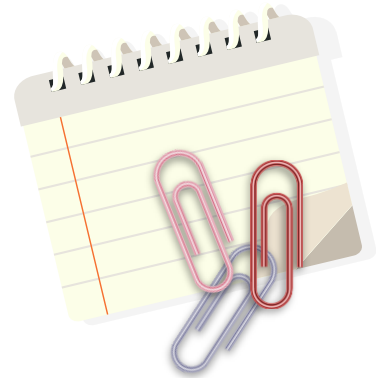
- When we want to show a small difference when making comparisons we can use “a little” or “a bit” and to show a big difference we can use “much” or “far”:

He’s **a bit** taller than me.

Switzerland is **much more expensive** than Italy.

Your house is **a little bigger than** my house.

This movie is **far more** interesting **than** the previous one.





Comparison of Equality

- To say that two things are the same, we can use *(just) as ... as*. With this structure we use the basic form of the adjective after **as**, not the comparative form.
- To say that two nouns are equal, the following formula is used:

As + adjective + as (tan + adjetivo + como)

She is **as tall as** her brother.

Today, a large coffee is **(just) as cheap as** a small one.

The Empire State is **as beautiful as** the Obelisk.

It's **as cold as** yesterday.





Comparison of inequality

- Comparatives are normally used to state superiority when you want to say that something is “more” than another. However, you can also use them to talk about inferiority. We can show inequality by using “less...than”:

A Mustang is **less expensive than** a Ferrari.

The Taj Mahal is **less famous than** The Great Wall of China.

My computer course was **less difficult than** my algebra course.



- We can also show inequality by using:

not + as + adjective + as

not + so + adjective + as

When we use these structures, the first thing mentioned is 'less' than the second thing. (The order of the things you are comparing is opposite to that used in comparisons of superiority).

This house isn't **as** big **as** the old one. (The old one is bigger than this one.)

Paris isn't **so** big **as** Tokyo. (Tokyo is bigger than Paris.)

SUPERLATIVE ADJECTIVES

GOOD
BETTER
BEST



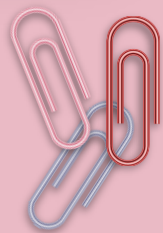
- A superlative adjective is used to compare three or more objects, people, or places. Using the superlative form takes a comparison to the highest or the lowest degree possible. In all cases, we add “**the**” before the superlative form:

John and his two brothers all play football, but John is **the best**.

The Burj Khalifa in Dubai is **the tallest** building in the world.

This beach is **the most** beautiful place in the world.

What was your **least** favorite subject or activity in school?



1 SYLLABLE: + -EST / -ST	OLD	THE OLDEST
	CHEAP	THE CHEAPEST
	NICE	THE NICEST
1 SYLLABLE: CONSONANT – VOWEL – CONSONANT: DOBLE CONSONANT + -EST	HOT	THE HOTTEST
	BIG	THE BIGGEST
	THIN	THE THINNEST
2 SYLLABLES ENDING IN –Y: -Y -IEST	HEALTHY	THE HEALTHIEST
	HAPPY	THE HAPPIEST
	EARLY	THE EARLIEST
2 OR MORE SYLLABLES: THE MOST/THE LEAST + ADJECTIVE	FAMOUS	THE MOST FAMOUS
	DIFFICULT	THE MOST DIFFICULT
	MODERN	THE MOST MODERN

- Some adjectives do not follow the rules (*-est* or *the most*) when they build their superlative form:



GOOD	BEST
BAD	WORST
FAR	FURTHEST/FARTHEST*
LITTLE	LEAST
MUCH / MANY	MOST

- When we talk about distance, both “furthest/farthest” are possible. However, when we mean extra or additional, we can only use “furthest”:

Among all his cousins he lives furthest from the lake.

The novel explores the furthest extremes of human experience.

Older vs. Elder Oldest vs. Eldest



- The adjective old has two possible forms in the comparative and superlative forms:

old – older/elder – the oldest/the eldest

- We can use **older/the oldest** in all contexts (people, things, places, etc.).

She is **older** than me.

The church is **the oldest** building in town.

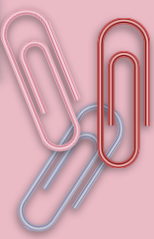
- In contrast, we only use **elder/the eldest** as attributive adjectives to refer to people, usually in the context of family relationships:

Diane is my **elder** sister.

Her **eldest** child is nearly 10.



PRACTICE





Comparative and superlative forms of adjectives:

- <https://test-english.com/grammar-points/b1-b2/the-the-comparatives/> (Section: Exercises).
- <https://english.lingolia.com/en/grammar/adjectives/adjectives/exercises> (Section: Exercise).
- <https://www.ego4u.com/en/cram-up/grammar/adjectives-adverbs/adjectives/exercises> (Section: Exercise).
- http://www.myenglishpages.com/site_php_files/grammar-exercise-grammar-comparatives-superlatives.php (Section: Exercise).



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